

If the American industrialists ^{with} whom Ilgner ~~met~~ ^{associated} just after Hitler seized power were thinking with truly progressive vision of ~~peace-through-exports,~~ they did not mention it to him. But many of them did point out to him that American industry was worried lest "peaceful trade with Germany would not continue." This was admirable first-insight and apparently Ilgner shared it. ^{Nevertheless, he} ~~But he still~~ believed that Farben could control the "radical elements" in the Party. As President of the Automobile Club, he invited a group of key American businessmen to take a "drive through the industrial territory". Several accepted. To them, Ilgner emphasized "that we industrialists would subsequently desire international cooperation. We were against exaggerated self-sufficiency. At that time, we had the world depression. I, myself, coined the phrase, 'We are all in the same boat.'"

Some American businessmen still doubted that Farben could influence Germany toward continued international cooperation. But there was no doubt that Ilgner was sincere and that his viewpoint was not at first shared in Nazi circles. His Nazi friends were all agreed that the last war had been lost in the market place (this resentful preoccupation with "The last war" kept cropping up). They were agreed also that Germany's standard-of-living could not improve unless ~~she~~ ^{she} got hold of raw materials she did not have. Some of them cried that the way to get there was "synthesis," and Ilgner, like ter Meer and Krauch, could not immediately persuade these Nazis that the expanded prosperity could not be borne entirely by white elephants.